

Daily Content Intel

June 18, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, here's the one that surprises a lot of coaches. Coaches pull their athletes off sprinting to keep the hamstrings safe, then hammer Nordic curls and call it prevention.

A pilot study in Cureus put EMG sensors on field athletes and measured hamstring activity across the big prevention exercises. Sprinting lit the hamstrings up the most, more than the Nordic curl, and way more than the isokinetic machine work.

That tracks with what the hamstring actually does. At top speed it's catching the leg as it swings forward, eccentric, at a long length, under huge load.

That's the exact moment hamstrings tear, so that's the exact moment you have to train.

Nordics are great, I still program them. But a Nordic is a slow drill, and a sprint is the real thing at game speed.

So here's Monday. Build sprinting in on purpose, a little at a time. Start with some buildups at 70 to 80 percent, then earn your way up to a couple of true max velocity runs each week, full recovery between them. The goal here is exposing the tissue to speed so it's ready when the game asks for it.

Treat sprinting like a skill you train and progress.

Hook: If your hamstrings keep grabbing, you're probably not sprinting enough.

Spoken script (word for word):

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sprinting to keep the hamstrings safe, then hammer Nordic curls and call it prevention.

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Treat sprinting like a skill you train and progress.

On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Hamstrings keep grabbing? You're not sprinting enough.
- 0:08 EMG study: sprinting > Nordic curl > isokinetic machine
- 0:25 Top speed = eccentric load at long length = where they tear
- 0:45 Nordics stay in. Sprinting is the missing piece.
- 0:58 Monday: 70-80% buildups, then 2 max-velocity runs/week, full rest
- 1:15 Train sprinting like a skill

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Hamstring that keeps barking on you? The fix might be the thing you've been avoiding.

A Cureus pilot study measured hamstring activation across the popular prevention exercises. Sprinting produced the highest activity, above the Nordic curl, with the isokinetic machine last. The hamstring's hardest job is catching your leg at top speed,

eccentric and long, which is exactly where strains happen. If you never get there in training, you're not ready for it in a game.

Keep your Nordics. Then add real speed, progressively: buildups at 70 to 80 percent, working toward 2 true max-velocity runs a week with full recovery. Expose the tissue to speed so the field doesn't surprise it.

Athletes and active adults both, this is how I keep hamstrings durable.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT Book:
threshold.clientsecure.me

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

#hamstring #speedtraining #footballtraining
#lacrosse #sprintspeed #athletedevelopment
#strengthandconditioning #injuryprevention
#returntosport #physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- Your HS football and club lacrosse guys log a ton of cutting and running, but how often do you actually program true max-velocity sprint days versus letting speed happen by accident in practice?

- Tell a return-to-sport story where you brought an athlete back through progressive sprint exposure: what the buildup ladder looked like, and how you knew the hamstring was ready for full speed.
- Where does sprint exposure sit inside CROSS for you, and how do you sell a parent or coach on "we need to sprint him" when their instinct is to rest a tweaky hamstring?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11378697/> | "Comparative Electromyographic Activity of Hamstrings During Sprinting Versus Strengthening Exercises: Implications for Injury Prevention"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11378697/> | "The results show significantly higher mean hamstring activity during sprinting ($0.4800 \pm 0.19 \mu\text{V}$) compared with strengthening exercises."
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11378697/> | "It is essential to

incorporate sprinting into rehabilitation without overloading the patient, as it is a high-intensity exercise enabling maximum recruitment of the hamstrings, fundamental in injury prevention."

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11378697/>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

I used to tell athletes the direction of the jump had to match the direction they sprint. Horizontal force for speed, so only broad jumps and bounds, box jumps are a waste. I hear coaches say it constantly.

A study in Scientific Reports actually tested it. They took semi-pro soccer players, split them into a horizontal jump group and a vertical jump group, 13 weeks, one plyo session a week. Then they measured sprint and change of direction.

Both groups got faster. Both improved their change of direction. And between the two groups, there was no meaningful difference.

What matters is that they jumped, with intent, consistently, and progressed the

load over time.

Here's what I'd actually obsess over. Are they landing clean and quiet? Are they fully recovered so each rep is explosive instead of mushy? Are you adding a little every few weeks? That's where the speed comes from.

Pick the jump you can coach well and your athlete can do safely, then go be relentless about quality. The argument about horizontal versus vertical is mostly noise.

Hook: Stop arguing about box jumps versus broad jumps. Your athletes don't care.

Spoken script (word for word):

I used to tell athletes the direction of the jump had to match the direction they sprint. Horizontal force for speed, so only broad jumps and bounds, box jumps are a waste. I hear coaches say it constantly.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Box jumps vs broad jumps? Athletes don't care.

- 0:10 Scientific Reports: horizontal vs vertical plyos, 13 weeks
- 0:30 Both got faster. No difference between groups.
- 0:45 The lever: intent, clean landings, progression
- 1:00 Land quiet, stay explosive, add load over time
- 1:12 Coach the jump you can coach well

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Hot take: the horizontal versus vertical jump debate is mostly noise.

Coaches love to say speed is horizontal force, so box jumps are useless and you should only bound and broad jump. A Scientific Reports trial put it to the test: semi-pro soccer players, 13 weeks, one plyometric session a week, one group horizontal and one vertical. Both groups improved sprint and change of direction, and there was no meaningful difference between them.

What moves the needle is intent, clean landings, full recovery between reps, and

progressive load over time. Pick the jump you can coach well and the athlete can do safely, then chase quality every single rep.

Works for football, lacrosse, basketball, any field or court athlete.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT Book:

threshold.clientsecure.me

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

#plyometrics #speedtraining #verticaljump
#broadjump #footballtraining #lacrosse
#basketballtraining #strengthandconditioning
#athletedevelopment #coaching

Personalize this

- In your weight room, which jump do you default to for your football and lacrosse athletes, and what made you pick it: coachability, equipment, or training age?
- Walk through how you progress a plyometric over a block: what you add and when, and how you judge whether a rep was explosive enough to count.
- You program through CROSS, so where do plyometrics live for you, and how do you explain to a parent why clean,

progressive quality beats a flashy
box-jump video?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10281993/> | "Effects of horizontal compared to vertical-based plyometric jump training on semi-professional soccer player's performance"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10281993/> | "HJ and VJ plyometric jump training are effective for improving the change-of-direction and a linear sprint of semi-professional players with no difference between types of intervention."
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10281993/> | "coaches are free to select the exercises based on the most relevant factors since the effects seem similar in semi-professional soccer players"

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10281993/>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Single-night sleep extension improves morning physical and cognitive performance (PMC12387293) — "bank an hour before game day" teaching reel.
- COD vs linear repeated sprint training, female college basketball, Scientific Reports 2026 (find an open mirror) — straight-line gassers do not build cutting ability.
- Plyometric training meta-analyses for jump/sprint/COD in adolescent and female athletes (PMC12477254, PLOS One 0319548).

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (newsletter_digest_2026-06-18.pdf): 3 sources, all promotional (Mercola "simplest compounds" advertorial, two Mike T. Nelson Flex Diet Cert sales emails). No clinical content to mine. Pulled both angles from the web scan instead.

- PubMed / PMC — hamstring injury prevention, sprint exposure, EMG of sprinting vs strengthening. Hit: Cureus 2024 EMG pilot (sprinting produces highest hamstring activation). USED for Draft A.
- PubMed / PMC — plyometric training, change of direction, sprint speed. Hit: Scientific Reports 2023 horizontal vs vertical plyometric trial (no between-group difference). USED for Draft B.
- nature.com (Scientific Reports COD vs linear repeated sprint, female college basketball, 2026) — redirected to an auth wall, not usable for screenshots. Skipped.
- MDPI (Sprint Training for Hamstring Injury Prevention scoping review, 2025) — HTTP 403, unreachable. Skipped, but corroborates the Draft A direction.
- Sleep extension (PMC12387293), plyometric meta-analyses (PMC12477254, PLOS One) — held as runner-ups.